



Scanners



There was a time when a scanner had to be from Umax. But the widespread networks—sales and service—of manufacturers such as Canon and HP seem to have had a swaying effect on buyers. While users of HP scanners had fewer problems and saw their problems being resolved sooner, users of Canon scanners were more satisfied with the quality of service. A third of HP users said they would buy another HP scanner; this number was about 66 per cent in the case of Canon.

Increasingly, scanners are being built into multifunction devices, and this seems to be the root of any displeasure. Says Swapnil Hoderkar from Pune, “I am not pleased with the HP scanner that I bought six months ago. I expected its performance to be much better—it is slow and the quality of the work at the end is not impressive. However, if HP

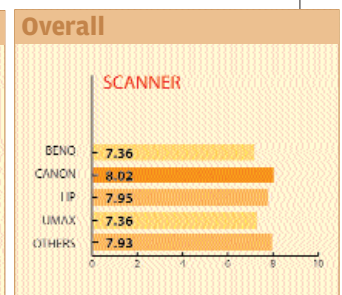
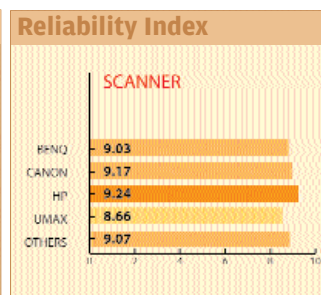
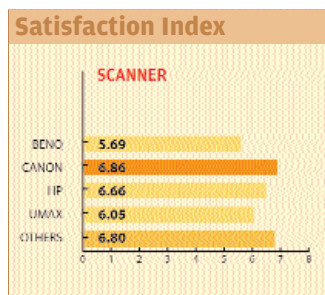
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improves its products with advanced technology, I might buy from them again.”

On the other hand, Nitin Baria from Jammu & Kashmir says, “Even after a year, my HP scanner has no problems and is dependable.”

The difference here is that Swapnil uses an MFD while Nitin has a standalone scanner. HPs loss, it would seem, is Canon’s gain!

Canon	
The Top Three	
Canon	8.02
HP	7.95
Others	7.93
Repurchase Index (%)	
HP	74
Others	73
BenQ	71



APC



UPS

The Top Three	
APC	8.17
Others	7.398
Microtek	7.93
Repurchase Index (%)	
APC	77
Microtek	70
Others	65

Most of you do not use an Uninterruptible Power Supply (UPS) at all. Either our State Electricity Boards are doing great at inspiring such confidence, or UPS providers are not doing enough to explain why a UPS is essential.

This is the most fragmented market of all the categories here. Only two brands, APC and Microtek, garnered enough votes to generate useful numbers.

Overall, the reliability of UPSes is, surprisingly, only a little better than that of desktop PCs. You might expect a relatively simple device such as this to work in an

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install-and-forget manner, but it demands more attention.

Rajwinder Singh, a disappointed owner of a Shark UPS, says, “I have had it with me for three years but had to replace it twice in that period. Though the company’s service is good, I do not find it reliable.”

Every eighth APC device, for example, needs to be sent for significant repair in a two-year span, but they fail the least often and have the shortest response time of 10 days, a week less than the industry average.

For a critical power conditioning function to be unavailable for a period of 10 days to a month is quite a risk for your computer. With such low service levels and a wide choice, it is not surprising that over 30 per cent of owners want to sample other brands. But, given the abysmal industry-wide performance, it may be a futile search.

